David Bacon

Instructional Designer | Westminster, MD, USA | +1 302 562 6093 | bacon.davidj@gmail.com

About

Educator and instructional designer with nearly 20 years of experience leading large-scale training programs and LMS adoption, including a 14-year program for 120 participants with 100% completion, built on data-driven design and clear stakeholder communication. I design interactive eLearning and branching scenarios in Articulate Rise and Storyline 360 using ADDIE, Bloom's Taxonomy, and Gagné's Nine Events, and use generative AI to speed development while keeping content aligned to learning objectives.

Skills

Articulate Rise · Blended Learning Design · Canvas LMS · ChatGPT · Data-Driven Instruction · eLearning Development · ElevenLabs · Google Classroom · Assessment & Evaluation · Coaching & Mentoring · Excel · Pear Deck · Performance Gap Analysis · Stakeholder Engagement · Workshop Facilitation · Adult Learning Theory · Blackboard · Curriculum Development · Instructional Design · Leadership Development · Needs Analysis · Outlook · PowerPoint · Slack · Articulate Storyline 360 · Word · Zoom · Scenario-based Learning · Branching Scenario Design · Canvas LMS Administration · Rubric Design · Instructor-led Training · Simulation Design · Assessment Design

Work Experience

Howard County Public School System (HCPSS)

Program Lead / Educator — Aug 2013 - Present

- Conducted a staff needs assessment via survey (35% reported positive morale), then facilitated a 20-person focus group to identify root causes and prioritize six improvement recommendations; presented findings to school leadership, who implemented four of six, and positive morale rose to 60% the following year.
- Designed and facilitated an annual week-long intensive training program for 120 participants over 14 years, sequencing complex skills into daily learning goals and checkpoints and tailoring content each cycle based on prior-year assessment data; 100% completed the program and met all objectives, culminating in a public exhibition.
- Designed and continuously improved a multi-year learning program for 150+ participants across 4 concurrent cohorts, integrating needs analysis, sequenced skill development, and performance assessment across 13 skill pathways; earned Excellent ratings across 11 consecutive evaluation cycles.
- Mentored 5 new teachers over 5 years through a formal mentorship program, using pre- and post-observation conferences across two evaluation cycles per mentee to analyze lesson design and outcomes; all 5 earned Highly Effective ratings and remain in the profession.
- Identified a Canvas LMS adoption need among colleagues and, without being asked, designed and delivered 5 training sessions for 30 teachers at my school, differentiating support for about 20 novice users and building extension activities for the 10 ready to go beyond the basics; all teachers in the building met Canvas implementation benchmarks (class pages, online gradebook and assignments, family communication), which most schools did not.
- Managed stakeholder relationships with school administrators, parents, and a parent-led booster organization for a 150+ participant program, leading monthly meetings of 20+ parents and translating program goals, budgets, and performance results into regular communication; identified budget reductions that saved $10K+ annually.
- Built consensus among parents for a $68K uniform purchase despite significant initial opposition, presenting the case, addressing objections, and securing approval.
- Planned and managed an annual event with 10,000+ attendees and a $45K budget, coordinating vendors, facilities, sponsorships, and 60 volunteers.

Self-initiated portfolio projects

Instructional Designer — Mar 2026 - Present

Independent Instructional Design Practice

- Designed First 90 Days: Onboarding New Managers, a 90-minute, three-module Articulate Rise course with three job aids, using a single ADDIE cycle: objectives written in Mager's ABCD format, cognitive demand sequenced with Bloom's Taxonomy, and a shared module structure built on Gagné's Nine Events; documented design rationale and revisions in a design document.
- Built Difficult Conversations, a 30-minute branching scenario in Articulate Storyline 360 for managers and supervisors, with a fictional needs assessment, choices that carry realistic consequences, immediate rubric-based feedback, and a quick-reference job aid.
- Developed Delivering Better Feedback, a 15-minute Articulate Rise microlearning module that builds feedback skills for a general audience.
- Applied generative AI across the instructional design process, including storyboarding, script drafting, and branching-scenario and simulation development, using structured prompts and a human review pass on every output for accuracy, tone, and alignment to learning objectives.

Chesapeake Public Schools

Educator — Aug 2010 - Jun 2013

- Launched curriculum sequencing and refined assessment routines across two organizations for 120-plus learners, standardizing expectations and improving program consistency to support performance readiness.
- Implemented blended learning strategies combining traditional instruction with technology-enhanced practice tools, coaching colleagues and emerging leaders to strengthen instructional skills and raise performance outcomes across 3 program cycles.
- Analyzed student performance data to create achievable action plans, differentiated instructional strategies, and real-world simulations, supporting improved outcomes for over 100+ learners across multi-grade programs in 2 school systems.
- Managed onboarding and curriculum alignment for cohorts of 25-plus participants, mapping objectives to measurable outcomes and coordinating logistics for performances and events to ensure instructional consistency.

Red Clay Consolidated School District

Educator — Aug 2006 - Jun 2008

- Designed and implemented a standards-aligned blended curriculum for 75 learners, incorporating formative assessments and technology-enhanced practice to accelerate skill mastery [increasing post-unit assessment proficiency by 30 percentage points].

Education

James Madison University — Aug 2010

Master of Music | Music Teacher Education

University of Delaware — May 2006

Bachelor of Science | Music Pedagogy